



ONCE AGAIN XVIII · PRE-DRAFT INJURY BOARD

As of September 5, 2026 · Draft: Saturday, October 17, 2026, 7:30 PM ET · NBA opening night: late October

Read this before you draft. The league rule is that if you trade for a player already listed DTD or O, you take on full risk regardless of any updated timeline. The same logic applies on draft night — nobody is getting a refund on a bad pick. Everything below is a snapshot; re-check the morning of the draft.

1. Out long-term these are the ones that end drafts

DiVincenzo and Watkins are effectively full-season losses. Sharpe and Miller do not return until March, which in this league means after the regular season is decided. Do not spend a real pick on any of them.

PLAYER	TM	POS	INJURY	EST. RETURN	STATUS	NOTE
Donte DiVincenzo	MIN	G	Ruptured right Achilles	Apr 1	Out	Surgery Apr 2026. Treat as a full-season loss.
Jamir Watkins	WAS	G	Torn ACL	Apr 1	Out	Surgery announced Jul 30.
Shaedon Sharpe	POR	G	Torn meniscus	Mar 1	Out	Six-month timeline from Aug 24.
Jordan Miller	LAC	G	Torn left rotator cuff	Mar 1	Out	Re-evaluated in six months from Aug 26.
Johnny Furphy	IND	G	Torn right ACL	Jan 1	Out	Injured last season.
Jimmy Butler III	GSW	F	Knee	Dec 1	Out	Early in recovery, only recently back on the court.
Moses Moody	GSW	G	Torn left patellar tendon	Dec 1	Out	Diagnosed Mar 2026.
Jayden Quaintance	SAS	F	Right knee surgery	Dec 1	Out	No timetable given at the time of surgery.
Richie Saunders	MEM	G	Knee	Dec 1	Out	2026 No. 32 overall pick.
Izaiah Nelson	ORL	F	Left ankle fracture	Nov 1	DTD	3-4 months from Jul 13 surgery.

2. Draft-day risk day-to-day, but the names that decide your season

All of these are officially day-to-day with an October 1 estimated return, so they are expected to be available. The risk is not availability — it is workload in the first month, and the recovery cases at the top of the list. Haliburton, Lillard and Tatum are the three that will swing this draft.

PLAYER	TM	POS	INJURY	EST. RETURN	NOTE
Jayson Tatum	BOS	F	Knee	Oct 1	Centrepiece of the offence again after the Jaylen Brown / Paul George trade.
Tyrese Haliburton	IND	G	Achilles	Oct 1	Said in June he feels "great." Still the biggest boom-or-bust call in round one.
Damian Lillard	POR	G	Achilles	Oct 1	Won the 2026 3-point contest. Now shares a backcourt with Ja Morant.
Jalen Brunson	NYK	G	Wrist	Oct 1	Surgery Jul 7 with a two-month rehab. Should be close to on time.
Giannis Antetokounmpo	MIA	F	Knee	Oct 1	Skipped FIBA qualifying to prepare for the season. New team.
Bam Adebayo	MIA	C	Back	Oct 1	Role may shift now that Giannis is alongside him.
Kevin Durant	HOU	F	Ankle	Oct 1	Averaged 26.0 ppg in his first Houston season.
Kyrie Irving	DAL	G	Knee	Oct 1	Expected fully healthy by the end of the offseason.
Trae Young	WAS	G	Quadriceps	Oct 1	Signed four years, \$212M with Washington.

Anthony Davis	WAS	F	Finger	Oct 1	Now sharing a frontcourt with No. 1 pick AJ Dybantsa.
Domantas Sabonis	SAC	C	Knee	Oct 1	Skipped FIBA qualifying to prepare for the season.
Zach LaVine	SAC	G	Hand	Oct 1	Picked up his \$49M option.
Franz Wagner	ORL	F	Calf	Oct 1	Skipped FIBA qualifying to prepare for the season.
Jaren Jackson Jr.	UTA	F	Knee	Oct 1	New team; Darryn Peterson joins him.
Ja Morant	POR	G	Elbow	Oct 1	Traded from Memphis; splits playmaking with Lillard.
Brandon Ingram	TOR	F	Heel	Oct 1	Listed by CBS; not on ESPN's board.
Aaron Gordon	DEN	F	Calf	Oct 1	More usage available after Peyton Watson was traded.
Jalen Williams	OKC	F	Hamstring	Oct 1	Dates to Game 7 of the conference finals.
Fred VanVleet	HOU	G	Knee	Oct 1	Exercised his \$25M option.
Bradley Beal	LAC	G	Hip	Oct 1	Signed two years, \$13.2M.
Isaiah Hartenstein	OKC	C	Ankle	Oct 1	Sat out FIBA qualifiers for Germany.
Immanuel Quickley	TOR	G	Hamstring	Oct 1	Missed the end of last season's first round.
Josh Giddey	CHI	G	Ankle	Oct 1	Chicago added Nic Claxton and two rookies.
Brandon Miller	CHA	F	Shoulder	Oct 1	Post-surgery rehab update given Aug 25.
Zach Edey	MEM	C	Ankle/elbow	Oct 1	Role muddled by the Cameron Boozier pick.
Dereck Lively II	DAL	C	Foot	Oct 1	Had not progressed to running as of late June.
Mark Williams	PHX	C	Foot	Oct 1	Re-signed three years, \$38M.
Steven Adams	HOU	C	Ankle	Oct 1	Underwent season-ending ankle surgery last season.
De'Andre Hunter	SAC	F	Eye	Oct 1	Usage competition from rookie Darius Acuff.
Keegan Murray	SAC	F	Ankle	Oct 1	Projected to start at power forward.
Jonathan Isaac	ORL	F	Knee	Oct 1	Re-signed on a one-year deal.

3. Depth and rookie watch day-to-day, low draft impact

Mouhamed Gueye ATL · F · Foot	Keshon Gilbert ATL · G · Hip	RayJ Dennis ATL · G · Achilles	Nolan Traore BKN · G · Knee
PJ Hall CHA · C · Ankle	Dailyn Swain CHI · G · Wrist	Zach Collins CHI · F · Toe	Rob Dillingham CHI · G · Wrist
Peyton Watson CLE · F · Hamstring	Santi Aldama DAL · F · Knee	Trevon Brazile DEN · F · Undisclosed	Yanic Konan Niederhauser LAC · C · Foot (Lisfranc)
Scotty Pippen Jr. MEM · G · Toe	Walter Clayton Jr. MEM · G · Knee	Karim Lopez MEM · F · Undisclosed	Jaylen Wells MEM · F · Toe
Trevor Keels MIA · G · Knee	Ryan Conwell MIA · G · Hip	Myron Gardner MIA · F · Ankle	Kevin Porter Jr. MIL · G · Knee
Micah Peavy NOP · G · Rest	Bryce McGowens NOP · G · Toe	Mohamed Diawara NYK · F · Finger	Ajay Mitchell OKC · G · Calf
Otega Oweh OKC · G · Lower leg	Thomas Sorber OKC · C · Knee	Nikola Topic OKC · G · Back	Kentavious Caldwell-Pope PHI · G · Finger
CJ Huntley PHX · F · Hamstring	David Jones Garcia SAS · F · Ankle	Nate Bittle TOR · C · Knee	Alijah Martin TOR · G · Knee
Chucky Hepburn TOR · G · Knee	Collin Murray-Boyles TOR · F · Finger	Trey Alexander UTA · G · Rib	Alex Sarr WAS · C · Foot

Sources: ESPN NBA Injury Status (data provided by Rotowire) and CBS Sports NBA Injury Report, both retrieved September 5, 2026. Where the two disagree, ESPN's status and estimated return date are used; Brandon Ingram (TOR) and Peyton Watson (CLE) appear on CBS only. Compiled for the Once Again league headboard by the commissioner's office.